

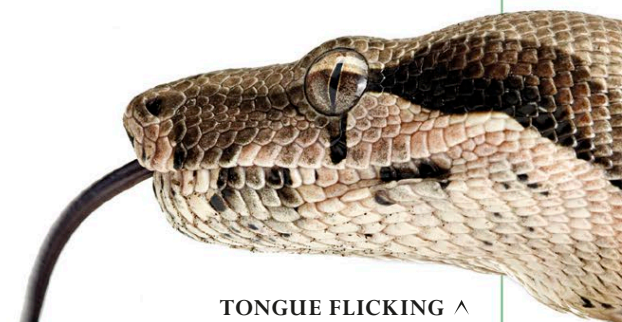
even when closed,
the mouth has an
opening that allows
the tongue to be
extended



< EYE

The boa has keen eyesight, and the pupil narrows to a slit in bright light. It has no eyelids. Around the eyes, the head is covered with numerous small scales, which are made of keratin.

forked tongue



TONGUE FLICKING ^

The forked tongue is an important sense organ. Snakes flick their tongues, collecting chemicals from the air; these are then analysed by the Jacobson's organ in the roof of the mouth.



REMNANT LIMBS ^>

All snakes lack limbs, but more primitive species like the common boa still possess the remnants of a pelvis, as well as tiny, spur-like hind limbs on each side of the anal vent – these would once have been legs.

